PRACTICAL CYBERSECURITY / SOC L1

FROM ALERT TO ACTION

Phishing Investigation & Incident Reporting

من رصد التنبيه إلى قرار أمني مدعوم بالأدلة

A REALISTIC SOC WORKFLOW

DETECT > INVESTIGATE > DOCUMENT > ESCALATE

MEDIUM
Alert severity

TRUE POSITIVE
Lab verdict

FIVE Ws
Reporting method

TRAINING ENVIRONMENT

A simulated TryHackMe SOC L1 case, reconstructed from original SIEM screenshots. No claim of real-world compromise, attachment execution, or containment.

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01 / THE ALERT

What the SIEM actually showed

Observable indicators from a post-delivery phishing alert. These are the facts visible in the simulated dashboard.

SENDER IDENTITY

Microsoft Support

Claimed sender: support@microsoft.com.

AUTHENTICATION

SPF: FAIL / DKIM: FAIL

Failed checks support spoofing suspicion.

SOCIAL ENGINEERING

600% PRICE INCREASE

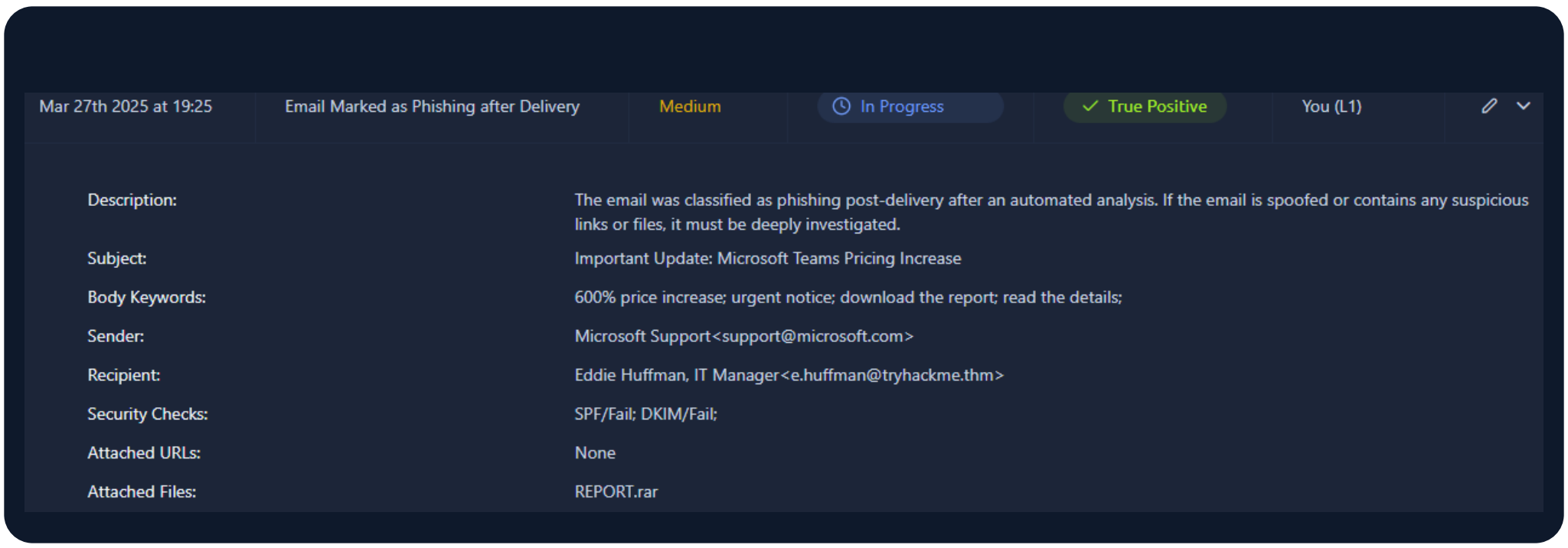
Urgency and demand to download a report.

ATTACHMENT

REPORT.rar

Suspicious archive: analysis still required.

EVIDENCE 01 / ORIGINAL SIEM ALERT DETAILS



The alert recorded medium severity and was marked True Positive within the lab. No attached URL was shown. The archive contents and execution status were not established by these screenshots.

02 / ANALYST NOTE

Five Ws: a report others can act on

The investigation is documented in a concise, evidence-first format so an L2 analyst can continue without guessing.

WHO	Eddie Huffman, IT Manager (e.huffman@tryhackme.thm), was the recipient. The message claimed to be from Microsoft Support.
WHAT	Post-delivery phishing alert for an email about Microsoft Teams pricing. A file named REPORT.rar was attached.
WHEN	27 March 2025, 19:25 - timestamp shown in the simulated SIEM alert (time zone not specified).
WHERE	The recipient corporate mailbox in the TryHackMe lab environment; not a production tenant.
WHY	Failed SPF/DKIM, urgent 600% price-increase claim, and a suspicious archive justify further investigation.

ASSESSMENT / TRUE POSITIVE

The lab classifies the suspicious email as phishing. This does not, by itself, prove the attachment was opened, executed, or caused compromise.

From triage to SOC L2

A practical L1 workflow: interpret the signals, document the evidence and request a focused deeper investigation.

01 DETECT > 02 VALIDATE > 03 REPORT > 04 HAND OFF

RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTIONS

Escalate to SOC L2 (E.Fleming in the training workflow). Examine REPORT.rar safely; validate the sender, check recipient interaction and assess any affected endpoint before deciding on containment.

EVIDENCE 02 / SIEM TRIAGE STATUS

Search for an alert

Time	Name	Severity	Status	Verdict	Assignee	Actions
Mar 27th 2025 at 19:56	Spike of Domain Discovery Commands	Medium	Awaiting action	None	None	
Mar 27th 2025 at 19:25	Email Marked as Phishing after Delivery	Medium	In Progress	True Positive	You (L1)	
Mar 27th 2025 at 19:10	Web Scanning of Corporate Resources	Low	In Progress	True Positive	E.Fleming (L2)	
Mar 27th 2025 at 18:30	Sensitive Document Share to External	Medium	In Progress	True Positive	E.Fleming (L2)	
Mar 27th 2025 at 18:02	Fast Beaconing to Untrusted Domain	High	Closed	False Positive	S.Todd (L1)	

EVIDENCE STANDARD

The screenshots establish an L1 triage decision and documented findings. They do not demonstrate execution of REPORT.rar, host isolation, eradication or recovery.